

Dashleen Kaur

PhD Candidate | University of British Columbia, Department of Economics
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Education

University of British Columbia , Vancouver, BC	August 2021 - Present
PhD in Economics (expected 2026)	
Delhi School of Economics , New Delhi, India	July 2016 - May 2018
M.A. in Economics, 79.87%; Ranked 1st (200+ students)	
Hans Raj College, University of Delhi , New Delhi, India	July 2013 - May 2016
Bachelor of Arts, Honors in Economics, 87.69%; Ranked 4th (150+ students)	

Research Experience

Research Assistant , University of British Columbia	April 2025 - Present
<i>Supervisor: Prof. Nathan Nunn</i>	

- Supporting research for book project on cultural change over history, examining which values have been more successful (spread through colonialism and European expansion) versus less successful in evolutionary terms
- Contributing to analysis of historical value transmission and cultural evolution patterns

Research Assistant , University of British Columbia	October 2022 - December 2023
<i>Supervisor: Prof. Heather Sarsons</i>	

- Supported an RCT on gender norms and female labor force participation in Odisha using NFHS and primary data
- Conducted scoping and pilots; designed survey modules and questionnaires; cleaned and analyzed pilot data in Stata
- Contributed to planning for main study implementation (measurement, sampling/field logistics, and data workflows)

Research Assistant , Centre for Development Economics, Delhi School of Economics	January 2020 - May 2021
<i>Supervisor: Prof. Rohini Somanathan</i>	

- Cleaned, managed, and analyzed Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) data in Stata; produced regular reporting
- Tracked central and state orders and linked policy timing to economic activity and pollutant concentrations

Research Associate , Department of Economics, King's College London	January 2019 - April 2020
<i>Supervisor: Prof. Amrita Dhillon</i>	

- Contributed to research on centralized vs. decentralized monitoring and corruption in India using PMGSY (2010-2018) and Census data
- Web-scraped administrative data; supported econometric framework development and analysis in Stata and R

Research Intern , ASER Centre (Pratham), New Delhi	May 2017 - August 2017
• Conducted field visits and contributed to a published report on DIET partnerships (2016-17)	

- Performed pre/post analysis of learning outcomes using Stata

Research Intern, Centre for Policy Research (CPR), New Delhi

May 2016 - July 2016

- Supported a study on inequalities in urban sanitation in Delhi; administered primary surveys (200+ respondents) in urban slums
- Analyzed access to toilets and basic amenities in relation to socioeconomic conditions and infrastructure constraints

Credit Risk Analyst, ICICI Bank

2018 - 2019

Publications

Afridi, F., Dhillon, A., Chaudhuri, A. R., & Kaur, D. (2020). Efficacy of Top down audits and Community Monitoring.

Research in Progress

Agency over Earnings and Female Labor Supply

January 2024 - Present

(with *Diego Delic*)

- Co-designed the intervention and randomization strategy
- Conducted field visits and stakeholder interviews in Delhi on gender norms and female labor supply
- Led pilot activities and co-led grant applications for scale-up

Effect of Co-education on Student Outcomes

October 2023 - Present

- Web-scraped and geo-coded data for 2,288 public schools in Colombia (2000-2020) using Google Maps API; linked to county-level covariates
- Implemented event-study (two-way fixed effects) to estimate impacts of switching from single-sex to co-ed schooling on academic outcomes

Peer Tutoring in Rural India

October 2023 - October 2024

(with *Palaash Bhargava, Nikhil Kumar, Madhavi Jha*)

- Led a study with the Government of Bihar on behavioral and mental health outcomes for 15,000 students, with emphasis on gender and caste dynamics
- Managed design, randomization, and baseline analysis; prepared for large-scale data collection and reporting

Politicized Judiciary: Testing Evidence in India

May 2022 - December 2022

- Question: Does a Hindu-nationalist government influence judicial outcomes, particularly for Muslim defendants?
- Identification: Leverages close election outcomes and quasi-random judge assignment to cases; tests whether outcomes vary with judge-defendant religious match under a pro-Hindu government
- Main result: Decisions appear to be biased under some circumstances on religious grounds in the setting studied

Awards and Fellowships

- Four-Year Doctoral Fellowship, University of British Columbia
- President's Academic Excellence Initiative Award, University of British Columbia
- International Tuition Award, University of British Columbia

- National Eligibility Test (NET) for Lectureship in Economics, UGC (India)
- Hiralal Bhargava Gold Medal, Delhi School of Economics (Ranked 1st)
- Shri Ram Behari Rohatagi Memorial Gold Medal, Delhi School of Economics (Best academic performance)
- K.C. Nag Memorial Prize, Delhi School of Economics (Outstanding student)
- EXIM Bank Scholarship, Delhi School of Economics

Research Grants

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| • The Agency Fund (with InvolveEDU) (\$350,000) | 2024 - 2026 |
| • Center for Effective Global Action (with Diego Delic) (\$2,500) | 2025 |
| • Weiss Fund, University of Chicago (with Diego Delic) (\$10,500) | 2024 |
| • CEGA-PEP Initiative (with InvolveEDU) (\$9,200) | 2024 |
| • Weiss Fund, University of Chicago (with Diego Delic) (\$4,500) | 2023 |

Skills & Interests

Technical: Stata, Python, $\text{\LaTeX}$, SurveyCTO (elementary proficiency), Microsoft Office

Languages: Fluent in English, Native in Hindi, Working proficiency in Spanish